AUTOMATED PAYMENT REMINDER SYSTEM

Workflow Automation Project using Zapier

Project Report

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1. Executive Summary

This project builds an automated payment reminder system with Zapier, Google Sheets and Gmail. It removes the repetitive work of checking invoices by hand and chasing customers for payment.

The workflow runs on a daily schedule. It reads the SCIT Invoice spreadsheet, checks the status of each record, and continues only with records marked Pending that have a valid designated recipient email. A personalised email is generated from the row data and sent through Gmail, and the row is then updated to show that the first reminder has gone out.

The project shows how a routine business task can be handled with no-code automation, and it lays the groundwork for later features: a second reminder, payment confirmation from email replies, and escalation of overdue payments.

2. Problem Statement

Following up on payments is usually manual: someone reviews invoice records, finds the outstanding ones, writes reminders and keeps track of what was sent. Done repeatedly, this takes administrative time and follow-ups can be missed or handled inconsistently.

This project replaces that routine with a scheduled automation that links invoice data to email. Instead of checking every invoice, the workflow evaluates the records itself and sends a reminder whenever the defined conditions are met.

3. Project Objectives

• Identify pending payment records in a spreadsheet automatically.

• Run the workflow on a daily schedule.

• Use conditional logic so only eligible records are processed.

• Generate personalised reminder emails from spreadsheet fields.

• Send the reminder from the designated Gmail account to the test recipient in the record.

• Update the spreadsheet row once the reminder has been sent.

• Track activity through Reminder Count and timestamp information.

• Provide a base for second reminders, payment confirmation and escalation.

4. Tools and Technologies

Tool	Role in the project
Zapier	Automation platform connecting the schedule, spreadsheet, filters and Gmail actions
Google Sheets	Holds the invoice records and receives updates after processing
Gmail	Sends the personalised reminder emails
Google Drive	Cloud storage where the spreadsheet is kept
CSV / Excel	Tabular format of the underlying payment data

5. System Workflow

The workflow runs in a fixed order: trigger, data retrieval, conditional filtering, email, then record update.

Step	Zapier component	Function
1	Schedule by Zapier	Starts the automation at the configured daily time
2	Google Sheets - Get Many Spreadsheet Rows	Fetches the invoice records from the SCIT Invoice worksheet
3	Filter by Zapier	Lets a record through only if Status = Pending and an Email value exists
4	Gmail - Send Email	Sends a personalised reminder using the invoice fields
5	Google Sheets - Update Spreadsheet Row	Updates the processed row, including Reminder Count and an optional timestamp

Summary: Schedule, retrieve rows, filter eligible records, send reminder, update spreadsheet.

6. Input Data Structure

The SCIT Invoice worksheet is the main data source. Its fields cover invoice details, payment status, reminder tracking and the recipient.

Field	Purpose
Sr	Serial / reference number
Invoice ID	Unique invoice identifier
Type	Payment or invoice type
Name	Used to personalise the email
Amount	Invoice amount
Account No	Bank account reference
Bank Name	Bank linked to the record
Status	Current payment status
Transaction ID	Transaction reference, when available
Reminder Count	Number of reminders already sent
Escalated	Whether the record has been escalated
Email	Designated test recipient address

7. Conditional Logic

A record qualifies for the first reminder only when:

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Status = Pending AND Email exists
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When the condition holds, the record moves on to the Gmail action. Records with Paid, Completed or any other status are skipped, and so are Pending records with no email. This prevents unintended or incomplete sends.

8. Payment Reminder Email

Each eligible invoice gets an email built from its own spreadsheet fields.

Subject: Payment Reminder - Invoice [Invoice ID] Due

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Dear [Name],

This is a friendly reminder that your payment for Invoice ID: [Invoice ID] of
Amount: Rs. [Amount] is currently pending.

Please find your payment details below for reference:
Account No: [Account No]
Bank Name: [Bank Name]
Payment Type: [Type]
Transaction ID: [Transaction ID]

Kindly ensure the payment is completed at the earliest to avoid any inconvenience.

If you have already made the payment, please disregard this message.

Thank you for your cooperation.

Regards,
Payments Team
```

9. Spreadsheet Update and Tracking

After the email is sent successfully, the automation updates the row. For the first reminder, Reminder Count changes from 0 to 1, and a Sent Timestamp field can record when it was processed. Status is not changed just because a reminder was sent; it stays Pending until payment is confirmed.

Stage	Reminder tracking	Status
Before reminder	Reminder Count = 0	Pending
After first reminder	Reminder Count = 1	Pending
After payment confirmation	Future workflow	Completed

10. Testing and Expected Results

The workflow is tested with the SCIT Invoice sample data.

Scenario	Expected action
Status = Pending, email available	Send personalised reminder
Status = Paid	Skip
Status = Completed	Skip
Status = Pending, email blank	Skip
First reminder sent successfully	Update Reminder Count to 1

11. Future Enhancements

• **Second reminder:** when Status = Pending, Reminder Count = 1, a Transaction ID exists and Escalated is not Yes, send a firmer email and set Reminder Count to 2.

• **Payment confirmation:** scan replies for messages confirming payment, then set Status to Completed and record the Transaction ID.

• **Escalation:** if payment is still pending after the defined reminder stages, notify the concerned authority and mark the record as escalated.

• **Reporting dashboard:** summarise pending invoices, reminders sent, completed payments and escalated records.

12. Conclusion

The Automated Payment Reminder System turns a repetitive finance task into a structured no-code workflow. Scheduled runs, spreadsheet retrieval, conditional filtering, dynamic emails and row updates together cut down manual effort while keeping basic tracking in place.

The current build covers the first reminder and provides a clear base for the second reminder, payment confirmation and escalation, which would complete the payment follow-up cycle.

13. Project Evidence and Submission Files

The project is documented on GitHub with the following files:

• README.md - project description, workflow and implementation details

• Prompt.md - instructions given to the Zapier agent

• Zapier screenshots - evidence of the configured workflow, filters and email execution

• This report - structured project documentation

Note: designated test recipient addresses are used for demonstration. Credentials, passwords and API keys must not be uploaded to GitHub.